

[GAME NAME] — QUICK REFERENCE (Core Rules v4)

Character Creation — 20 Points

Everything starts at d4, Adept health, two free Traits, 25 gold. Every point spent in one place is a point missing somewhere else.

Purchase	Cost	Purchase	Cost
Attribute d4→d6	3	Task Specialty (max 3)	2
Attribute d6→d8	5	Additional Trait (max 2)	3
Attribute d8→d10	9	Spell School, needs Focus d6 (max 2)	4
Health: Skirmisher 7 / Frontline 9 / Bulwark 11	3 / 6 / 10	Creation Feature (max 1)	4
+2 Daily Reserve (max 5)	1	+50 gold (max 4)	1
Armor: light / medium / heavy	1 / 2 / 3	Martial weapons · Heavy · Shields	2 · 1 · 1
Arcane Vestments · Armaments	2 · 2	Level 1 grants no Talent	—

Your Turn: 3 Action Points

Every action costs **1 AP** — **no exceptions**. Reserve and Momentum spend governs how *strong* your actions are; AP only governs how *many*.

Category	Baseline actions (1 AP each)
Attacks	Basic Attack: 1 Attribute Die (Vigor melee / Agility ranged or Finesse), no cost. Featured Attack: + Reserve/Momentum cost from its Talent or spell entry.
Defends	Guard: Impact Rolls against you are Downgraded until your next turn (tunable).
Maneuvers	Move up to Base Speed (repeatable) · Stand from Prone · Disengage (no Opportunity Attacks this turn).
Interactions	Draw/stow a Readied item · retrieve Stowed · use object · treat a wound / extinguish · Scrutinize an illusion.
Spellcasting	Cast a spell (+ its Reserve cost by Tier) · drive a Channel (any other AP spent breaks it).

Reactions: one per round, regained at the start of your turn — Opportunity Attacks, Grab/Redirect/Parry (free hand), Intercept (shield), Reaction spells and Talents. **Free-Action riders** trigger off actions and cost Momentum or Reserve, never AP.

Impact Rolls — no to-hit, ever

1) Roll your Impact Pool. 2) Add the dice. 3) Subtract the target's Defense Rating; the remainder is damage. **Glancing Blow** (total ≤ Defense): zero damage, attacker gains 1 Momentum. **Explosion:** a die at maximum rerolls and adds — infinitely. **Vicious:** exploding dice Upgrade one step per cascade. Max **one bonus die** per roll unless a feature says otherwise; extra points Upgrade that bonus die instead.

Die	d4	d6	d8	d10	d12
Defense (max/2)	2	3	4	5	6

Momentum

Personal pool, **cap 3** (Talents raise it). **Resets to 0 when combat starts**. Generate: your attack Glances +1 · your spell is Saved against +1 · your Task fails by 1–2 +1 / by 3+ +2 · plus your generator Talents. Spend (declare before rolling): **flat** — 1 token = +1 to your roll or an ally's within engagement (shareable); **Talent** — effects priced in the Talent's entry, always self-only.

Cover & Positioning

Light Cover (1/3 obscured): +1 Vigor/Agility Defense, attacker Downgrades Impact Die. **Heavy Cover** (1/2 obscured): +2, attacker Downgrades whole pool; fully hidden = untargetable. Cover never helps against Focus/Resolve attacks. Force damage ignores Cover. Leaving melee reach without Disengaging provokes an Opportunity Attack (their Reaction).

Tasks & Saves

Difficulty	Target	Feels like
Routine	3	Trained people manage it under pressure
Challenging	5	Demands skill and focus
Demanding	7	Limit of reliable achievement
Extreme	9	Legendary careers are made of these

Fail by 1–2: near miss, +1 Momentum. Fail by 3+: complication, +2 Momentum. Assist: helper rolls vs 3; success Upgrades the actor's die (one helper max). Group Task: majority carries. **Saves** use the same mechanic but are reactive; your own failed Save generates nothing — a resisted caster gains 1 Momentum.

Spell Tiers

Tier	Reserve	Impact Dice	Save Difficulty
0	0	1 Focus Die	5
1	1–2 Focus	1 Focus Die	5
2	3–4 Focus	2 Focus Dice	7
3	5–6 Focus	3 Focus Dice	9

Sustained: 1 Focus at the start of your turns + Concentration Save when damaged (Focus Die vs 5 + 2×tier). Channeled: 1 AP each turn; any other action breaks it.

Conditions (one-liners)

Dazed no Reactions; next Impact Die Downgraded	Sundered –1 to a named Defense (stacks, floor 0)
Bleeding 2 True Damage/turn until treated (1 AP)	Burning stated Fire damage/turn until doused (1 AP)
Restrained Speed 0; attacks vs you Upgraded	Grappled Speed 0; 1 AP + Vigor Save 5 to break
Prone Speed 0 until you stand (1 AP); melee vs you Upgraded, ranged Downgraded	Slowed Speed reduced; no Speed bonuses
Blinded your Impact Rolls Downgraded; no Cover	Silenced no speech, no Verbal spells
Frightened Downgraded vs source; can't approach it	Exhausted all four Attribute Dice Downgraded
Invisible/Concealed attacks vs you Downgraded	Hidden untargetable by single-target attacks
Incapacitated no actions, movement, or speech	Marked source's allies gain the stated benefit

Dying, Healing, Resting

0 HP: Incapacitated; Vigor Save vs 5 each turn — three successes stabilize, three failures kill, a max roll that Explodes puts you up at 1 HP. Any healing brings you back up. **Short Rest** (30 min + supplies): heal a Vigor Die roll. **Long Rest** (6h + 2h light): full HP and all Reserves; Decay cleansed.